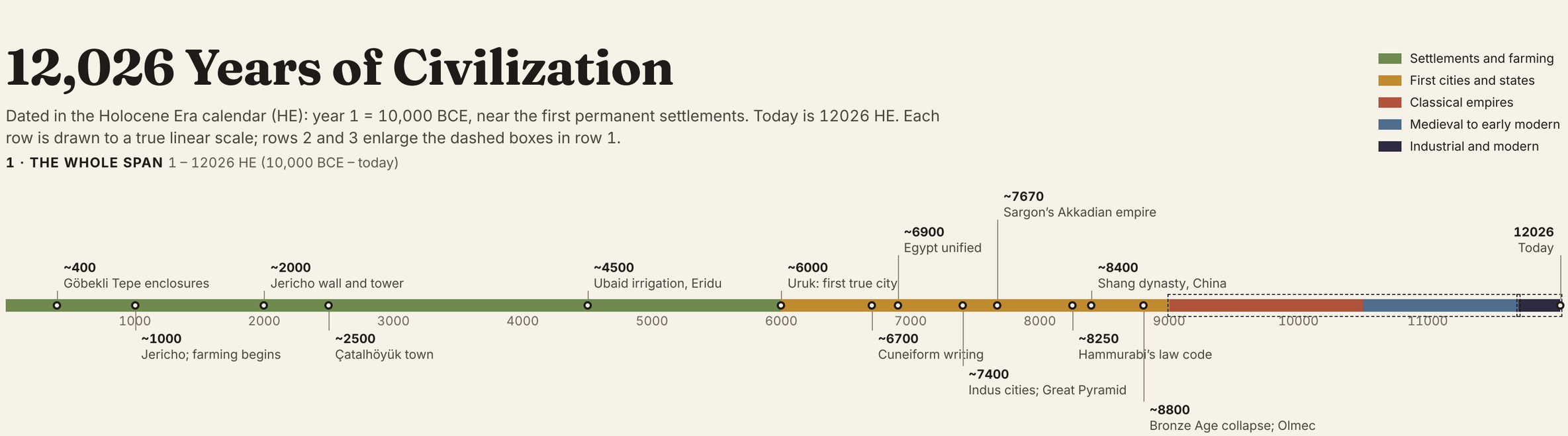
12,026 Years of Civilization

Dated in the Holocene Era calendar (HE): year 1 = 10,000 BCE, near the first permanent settlements. Today is 12026 HE. Each row is drawn to a true linear scale; rows 2 and 3 enlarge the dashed boxes in row 1.



Conversion: HE = CE year + 10,000. For a BCE year, HE = 10,001 − BCE (there is no year zero). Dates marked ~ are approximate; before about 8000 HE they carry uncertainties of a century or more. Writing appears near 6700 HE, so everything ever written down fits in the last 44% of row 1.

Holocene calendar proposed by Cesare Emiliani, 1993